HARMONY · INVERSIONS · LEARN

Inversions

REMEMBER Root at the bottom: root position. 3rd at the bottom: 1st inversion. 5th at the bottom: 2nd inversion.

1 Which position?

★☆☆

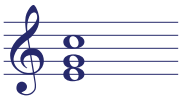
Circle the position of each C, F or G major chord (read from the bottom note up). The first is done.

C E G	**root** · 1st · 2nd
E G C	root · 1st · 2nd
G C E	root · 1st · 2nd
A C F	root · 1st · 2nd
C F A	root · 1st · 2nd
B D G	root · 1st · 2nd
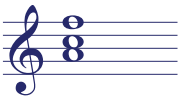
2 Find the root

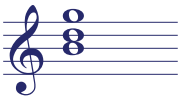
★★☆

Restack each chord in 3rds and write its root. The first is done.

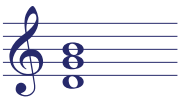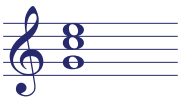


C











3 Write the inversions

★★☆

Write each chord in its 1st and 2nd inversion. The first row is done.

CHORD	ROOT POSITION	1ST INVERSION	2ND INVERSION
C	C E G	**E G C**	**G C E**
F	F A C		
G	G B D		
Am	A C E		

Date _____

HARMONY · INVERSIONS · USE

Inversions

REMEMBER Keep any shared note; move the others to the nearest note of the next chord.

1 Draw the 2nd inversion ★★☆

Next to each chord, draw its 2nd inversion: lift the two bottom notes to the top. Example: C E G becomes G C E.



2 Slash chords ★★☆

Write the notes from the bottom up. The first is done.

SYMBOL	NOTES, BOTTOM UP
C/E	E G C
G/B	
F/A	
Am/C	

3 The common note ★★☆

Write the note (or notes) the two chords share. The first is done.

CHORDS	SHARED	CHORDS	SHARED
C and F	C	Am and F	
C and G		Em and C	

4 Name it ★★☆

Write the chord symbol with its bass note, like C/E. The first is done.



C/E _____ _____ _____ _____

5 Play it smoothly ★☆☆

Play C E G, C F A, B D G, C E G, left hand; then in G: G B D, G C E, F♯ A D, G B D.

in C ○ ○ ○ ○ **in G** ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____